



DELHI | The Summit Jinx

Non-Aligned summits have come to be haunted by a strange Pakistan jinx that the Indian establishment finds hard to shake off. The recent Indo-Pak joint statement on the sidelines of the NAM Summit in the Egyptian resort of Sharm el-Sheikh has forced the Government into damage control mode with questions being raised about India's 'surrender'. The statement delinked the composite dialogue process from terrorism and made a mention of the strife in Balochistan. Pakistan has moved quickly to exploit this part of the statement, accusing Delhi of being involved in the discord that has unsettled Balochistan. India may just be forced to dilute its demand that Pakistan take strict action against terrorists. This is not the first time India has bungled a joint statement. At the NAM Summit in Havana 2006, India first conceded to Pakistan's then president Pervez Musharraf that Pakistan was a victim of terrorism too and agreed to set up a joint anti-terror mechanism that backfired. Pakistan has never kept its pledge to stop cross-border terrorism. Ironically, the same set of experts who drafted the Havana joint statement are being blamed for Sharm el-Sheikh. So while the NAM jinx may have kicked in, the Government needs to find a cure for its drafting worries which are undermining India's efforts in curbing terrorism emanating from Pakistan.

**MANMOHAN
SINGH (RIGHT)
WITH PAKISTAN
PRIME MINISTER
YOUSUF RAZA
GILANI AT
SHARM EL-
SHEIKH**

by Saurabh Shukla

4

is the number of drafts of the Indo-Pak joint statement that India carried to the NAM Summit in Egypt. None were used.